

putational speed rated at sixty trillion operations per second.

HAL 9000

While Asimov's greatest accomplishments in sci-fi AI were the positronic brain and the Three Laws of Robotics, Arthur C. Clarke dealt more with a non-humanoid form of artificial intelligence. In *2001: A Space Odyssey*, the world was introduced to the HAL 9000 – an intelligent super-computer whose many technologies were rooted in the science of the time. While Clarke did write a book of the same name, it's the film adaptation by Clarke and Stanley Kubrick that captured the imagination of the world.

The HAL 9000 is essentially a computer; indeed, it's an abbreviation for Heuristic ALgorithmic computer. In the film, HAL 9000 is part of a space mission to Jupiter with a group of astronauts, including the protagonists Dr. David Bowman and Dr. Frank Poole. Throughout the movie, HAL is shown as a supremely sentient being capable of a wide range of intelligence previously thought to be exclusive to the human brain. He plays chess with the humans, talks to them, appreciates art and runs the entire ship.

But a conflicting set of orders (the ship has a secret mission told only to HAL which he has to hide from the astronauts – thus introducing him to the concept of lying when he has no programming for it) starts a chain of events that sends HAL down a dark path. When he makes his first error, Bowman and Poole grow suspicious.



Star Trek's Data was another such AI character



The face Of HAL 9000